

1947, March 5.

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed draft of the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST. FELIX FRIARY
Huntington, Indiana
March 5th 1947.

Mrs. Maxine Cavanaugh 10 Crescent Ave. Muskegon Heights, Michigan

My Dear Madam: God bless you and yours.

I have just read your pathetic letter and do surely sympathize with both you and your husband, - with him possibly the more, because of his greater danger of losing his soul, unless you be induced to turn back to God.

You tell me as much as that our friend Grace Panyard guided you hither and again that you are not "of my faith". Whatever you be, you have an immortal soul - your ownself - to save for God; and I am glad to help you do that.

I presume that you are a Christian of some denomination. If I am right, then in saying you do not belong to my faith, you err in a way; because there is only one Christianity. Think a little and see if I'm right. I go further. If religion can be defined as a science, and I claim it is not only a science but the very greatest science of all times and of every generation; in fact the only science that in the end counts for aught, and without which all other sciences are vain allusions. Ah! "RELIGION, THE SCIENCE OF OUR HAPPY RELATIONSHIP (dependence on), WITH GOD AND OUR NEIGHBOR".

Furthermore, while there may be a thousand different systems of that science -- a thousand various denominations - the science of religion remains one. Its up to the individual with the use of reason, cooperating with God's grace to find which is the best system and to choose it rather than any other. On his choice depends to a vast extent, his own peace and that of the community - as well as their hope for eternal happiness hereafter.